

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

SENATE CONCURRENT
RESOLUTION 22

By: Nice of the Senate

and

Hefner of the House

AS INTRODUCED

A Concurrent Resolution recognizing the impact of light pollution on bird mortality; and encouraging Oklahoma businesses, state agencies, organizations, and residents to turn off any exterior lighting during the high migration intensity months of April, May, September and October.

WHEREAS, the State of Oklahoma and the Oklahoma Animal Coalition aim to provide birds safe passage during migration periods by reducing light pollution, as well as building and glass collisions, through the Lights Out Oklahoma campaign; and

WHEREAS, birds help with the control of pests, carrion regulation, pollination, and seed dispersal while adding beauty and connecting people to nature and the outdoors; and

WHEREAS, birdwatching is an economic driver in the State of Oklahoma and is a fun, relaxing, multigenerational, educational and wellness activity for all; and

1 WHEREAS, a wide diversity of birds in Oklahoma indicates a
2 healthy environment; and

3 WHEREAS, Oklahoma is part of the central flyway through which
4 approximately 400 different species of birds migrate during the
5 spring and fall; and

6 WHEREAS, the Oklahoma state bird, the scissor-tailed flycatcher,
7 is one of the many species of birds that migrate to our state to
8 nest and rear their young; and

9 WHEREAS, most birds migrate at night, navigate by using the
10 stars and moon, and can become disoriented by bright artificial
11 light and sky glow, resulting in exhaustion and deadly collisions
12 with buildings, glass, power lines, and vehicles; and

13 WHEREAS, collisions with buildings is one of the top causes of
14 mortality of birds in the United States; and

15 WHEREAS, the Lights Out Oklahoma program strategy is aimed to
16 persuade building owners and managers and homeowners to turn off
17 exterior lighting on all buildings at night during the high
18 migration intensity months of April, May, September and October; and

19 WHEREAS, these measures save energy and money and protect birds
20 migrating to nesting grounds in the spring and wintering grounds in
21 the fall; and

22 WHEREAS, Oklahoma joins the international community and states
23 including Texas, Colorado, Kansas, Missouri and Florida in
24 sponsoring Lights Out projects to protect birds during migration.

1 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE 2ND SESSION
2 OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
3 CONCURRING THEREIN:

4 THAT the Oklahoma State Legislature supports reducing bird
5 mortality in the areas and encourages Oklahoma businesses, state
6 agencies, organizations, and residents to turn off any exterior
7 lighting during the high migration intensity months of April, May,
8 September and October.

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